

MSI Wind U100

Wind Of Change

MSI has been quick to bring their Wind Netbook to India, and we received the 6-cell version. With Intel releasing their Atom processors, all the top laptop manufacturers have been focussing on making compact and cheap laptops for the masses. ASUS' 10-inch Eee PC 1000H is direct competition to the MSI Wind.

The MSI Wind has a 6-cell battery and a 10-inch screen, and pretty much the same configuration as the Eee PC 1000H. The body has a matte finish, and its curved edges give it a very compact look.

There are a few other differences between the MSI Wind and the ASUS EeePC: the keyboard, although similarly spaced, is positioned weirdly. The Function key sits on the extreme left bottom of the keyboard, where the [Ctrl] key should be. There are status indicators for most of the features that you control using the Function keys. The touchpad is a little small, and the two mouse clickers have been

integrated into one large button.

An Intel Atom 1.6 GHz processor powers the MSI Wind along with 1 GB of RAM and an 80 GB Western Digital drive.

The build quality in general isn't as good as the ASUS Eee PC. The hinge, for example, doesn't feel as sturdy, which means with the Wind you have a screen that literally will flap in a strong wind. The keys feel a little cheaply put together as well.

There's really nothing to set the Wind apart from the Eee PC in terms of performance though, and this is because of the almost identical hardware in use. SiSoft recorded a hard drive index of 47 MBps, and our video encoding test took close to four and a half minutes.

Although the 802.11n standard is not the norm just yet, it seems significant enough to mention that the Eee PC supports it, while the Wind does not.

The screen quality is more or less what we've come to expect from

Netbooks. It's important that you realise that although screens on Netbooks aren't as vibrant as those on regular sized laptops, it's the high 1024 x 600 resolutions on smaller screens that cause these screens to look very crisp and sharp.

The center of the laptop gets a little warm and the vents on the side of the MSI Wind are quite large. The Wind's 6-cell battery sticks out from the bottom of the notebook instead of the back. This adds to its compact profile.

The webcam quality is average. The audio quality isn't very impressive either but it is better than the Acer. The charger is a little bulkier than the one supplied with the EeePC as well.

Overall, the MSI Wind is a great laptop and it lies in between the Acer One and the ASUS EeePC 1000H in price. In terms of features, it lags behind the Eee PC

1000H, but the 6-cell version of the MSI Wind is priced at Rs 29,000. This makes it a little expensive as compared to the MSI Wind. As long as the EeePC 6-cell is priced around the same as the MSI Wind, the Eee PC remains the better option. If you can get the Wind for over Rs 1,500 cheaper, it's worth considering.

Specifications

Intel Atom N270 1.6 GHz, 1 GB DDR2 667 MHz RAM, 80 GB HDD, 10" 1024 x 600 LCD screen, 6-cell battery

Contact: MSI
Phone: 18002000004
E-mail: marketing@msi-in.com
Web site: www.msi-india.com
Price: Rs 29,000

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



Samsung SCX-4300

Print In Style

The SCX-4300 is the latest in the successful SCX series of multi-function devices from Samsung.

The SCX-4300 looks terrific in its black outfit and will definitely look good on any desk. The wider and deeper SCX-4300 now allows buttons and two lines, 16 character LCD display on the front console. The paper cassette has healthy 250 page capacity and the output tray can hold around 50 sheets.

What's even more impressive is the fact that the device is able to produce first print within 11 seconds. While most MF device print and scan well they don't do that good when copy function is used which requires both the scanner engine and print engine to work in a serial

manner. The SCX-4300 is able to deliver first copy within 13 seconds, the best we have seen in the small device category.

In our document printout tests the SCX-4300 delivered exceptional quality, however with just 600x600 dpi resolution and half toning, graphics don't come out well. We tried printing line graphs, pie charts, bar graphs and they came out well, but similar results were not seen when photographs were printed. Print quality suffers a bit with the copy function.

The scanner unit on the SCX-4300 is moderately fast at scanning and takes around 20 seconds to complete a 150 dpi A4 colour photograph. The scanner output quality is moderate; nothing to write home



about. Details are captured well with sharpness kept within check.

At Rs 8,300, the SCX-4300 is an excellent buy for the features on offer. If you want a sturdy, low volume laser MF device then SCX-4300 makes good sense and we recommend it.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Specifications

19 PPM, 600x600 dpi resolution, 1-99 copy, 600 x 2400 dpi scanner, scan to PC, 250 sheet cassette, 8 MB buffer, 10,000 monthly duty cycle, 21 kg.

Contact: Samsung India Electronics Pvt. Ltd.,
Phone: 011-41511235
E-mail: m.aditya@samsung.com
Web site: www.samsung.com.in
Price: Rs 8,300

Epson Stylus Photo 1390

Colourful Business

The Epson Stylus Photo 1390 is not exactly meant for home-based printing that is why we think the company has paid lesser importance to the looks and beautification of this mammoth printer.

To start with the Epson Stylus Photo 1390 gets its big size due to its ability to print A3 borderless prints. The printer utilises Epson's patented INKdividual 6 colour cartridge system. The Epson Stylus Photo 1390 offers print resolutions of up to maximum of 5,760 x 1,440 dpi, along with advanced Variable Sized Droplet Technology (VSDT), which allows the printer to utilise different size ink droplets as per the job requirement.

The Epson Stylus Photo 1390 comes bundled with

Epson's very own photo printing utility. This utility allows the user to print with the optimum quality. The utility also allows you to do some minor corrections to the pictures too. The inclusion of Adobe RGB support for SLR class printing and RAW file support for this printer is an added advantage for photo enthusiasts.

Printing speed is good and speedy enough to finish your chores in time, the Epson Stylus Photo 1390 took 34.1 seconds to print a full A4 page text and images in colour, while an A4 photo print (best quality, borderless) took just 2 minutes and 25 seconds to complete.

Quality of prints was good but not the best, because even at best settings there was



some loss in picture sharpness. The good thing is that in a borderless print we did not see any grains that are common in most colour photo inkjet printers.

So finally to sum it all up Epson Stylus Photo 1390 is a photo class printer that per-

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

forms jobs at the best possible time and gives you a plethora of features and is surely to be on the top list of photo enthusiasts.

Specifications

Print resolutions of up to 5,760 x 1,440dpi, borderless printing support for A3 size.

Contact: Epson India Pvt Ltd
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E-mail: think@eid.epson.co.in
Web site: www.epson.co.in
Price: Rs 19,999